

Assignment 2: Peer-to-Peer File Synchronizer

Report (Base + Patch Feb 27)

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The complete repository, including source code, documentation, and test files, is available on GitHub:

<https://github.com/ZifanSi/p2p-file-synchronizer>

Source files and scripts are located in the `src/` directory, documentation are located in the `docs/` directory.

1 Overview

This P2P file synchronizer uses a central tracker to coordinate file sharing and keep peer directories in sync.

Peer workflow:

- Connects to the tracker via a persistent TCP connection.
- Sends local file names and timestamps to the tracker.
- Sends keepalive signals every 5 seconds to stay active.
- Downloads missing or outdated files discovered through the tracker.
- Acts as a server to send files to other peers using a size header.

2 Environment

- OS: Windows 10/11 (local testing)
- Python: 3.12.10
- Network: localhost (127.0.0.1)

3 Project Layout Used for Testing

```
src/  
  bats/  
    clean_peer.bat  
    clean_port.bat  
  Peer1/  
    fileA.txt  
  Peer2/  
    fileB.txt  
  Peer3/
```

```
fileC.txt
(generated in TC6) big.bin
tests/
  compare_files.py
  tc_4.py
  tc_5.py
  tc_6.py
fileSynchronizer.py
run_all.bat
tracker.py
```

4 How to Run

```
cd src
```

Option A: Run with the provided batch script (recommended)

```
(optional: reset peer folders to initial state with only fileA/B/C)
bats\clean_peer.bat
(optional: stop all peers and tracker; useful for clean restarts)
bats\clean_port.bat
```

```
run_all.bat
```

Option B: Run manually without run_all.bat

Open 4 terminals.

Terminal 1 (Tracker):

```
cd src
python tracker.py 127.0.0.1 9000
```

Terminal 2 (Peer1):

```
cd src\Peer1
python ..\fileSynchronizer.py 127.0.0.1 9000
```

Terminal 3 (Peer2):

```
cd src\Peer2
python ..\fileSynchronizer.py 127.0.0.1 9000
```

Terminal 4 (Peer3):

```
cd src\Peer3
python ..\fileSynchronizer.py 127.0.0.1 9000
```

5 Protocol Summary

5.1 Peer → Tracker

Messages are newline-terminated UTF-8 JSON objects.

- Init (sent exactly once on startup):

```
{"port": <p>, "files": [{"name": "...", "mtime": <int>}, ...]}\n
```

- KeepAlive (sent every 5 seconds):

```
{"port": <p>}\n
```

5.2 Tracker → Peer

For every Init/KeepAlive received, the tracker returns one directory response (newline-terminated JSON):

```
{"fileA.txt": {"ip": "...", "port": ..., "mtime": ...}, ...}\n
```

5.3 Peer ↔ Peer

Requester sends:

```
<filename>\n
```

Server responds:

```
Content-Length: <size>\n<raw file bytes>
```

6 Rubric Coverage Map

The following test cases are designed to cover every graded requirement:

- TC0: `get_file_info()` (1pt)
- TC1: `get_next_available_port()` (1pt)
- TC2: `FileSynchronizer` initializer + tracker communication (1pt)
- TC3: `sync()` discovery + retrieve missing files (1pt)
- TC4: `sync()` overwrite newer mtime + `os.utime()` (1pt)
- TC5: `process_message()` serves file with correct **Content-Length** framing (2pt)
- TC6: timeout/failure handling + discard partial file (1pt)

7 Selected Runtime Output Evidence (localhost run)

The following excerpts are copied from an actual run on localhost using:

- Tracker port: **9000**
- Peer1 port: **8000**
- Peer2 port: **8001**
- Peer3 port: **8002**

Tracker (excerpt)

```
Waiting for connections on port 9000
Client connected with 127.0.0.1:51543
Client connected with 127.0.0.1:51545
Client connected with 127.0.0.1:51546
client server127.0.0.1:8000
client server127.0.0.1:8001
client server127.0.0.1:8002
```

Peer directory responses (excerpt)

```
Peer1:
Waiting for connections on port 8000
('connect to:127.0.0.1', 9000)
received from tracker: {"fileA.txt": {"ip": "127.0.0.1", "port": 8000, "mtime":
    1771289241}}
received from tracker: {"fileA.txt": {"ip": "127.0.0.1", "port": 8000, "mtime":
    1771289241},
    "fileB.txt": {"ip": "127.0.0.1", "port": 8001, "mtime": 1771289244},
    "fileC.txt": {"ip": "127.0.0.1", "port": 8002, "mtime": 1771289247}}

Peer2:
Waiting for connections on port 8001
('connect to:127.0.0.1', 9000)
received from tracker: {"fileA.txt": {"ip": "127.0.0.1", "port": 8000, "mtime":
    1771289241},
    "fileB.txt": {"ip": "127.0.0.1", "port": 8001, "mtime": 1771289244}}

Peer3:
Waiting for connections on port 8002
('connect to:127.0.0.1', 9000)
received from tracker: {"fileA.txt": {"ip": "127.0.0.1", "port": 8000, "mtime":
    1771289241},
    "fileB.txt": {"ip": "127.0.0.1", "port": 8001, "mtime": 1771289244},
    "fileC.txt": {"ip": "127.0.0.1", "port": 8002, "mtime": 1771289247}}
```

Figure 1: Output of the P2P File Synchronizer

File Structure Before:

- src/
 - Peer1/ (fileA.txt)
 - Peer2/ (fileB.txt)
 - Peer3/ (fileC.txt)

File Structure After:

- src/
 - Peer1/ (fileA.txt, fileB.txt, fileC.txt)
 - Peer2/ (fileA.txt, fileB.txt, fileC.txt)
 - Peer3/ (fileA.txt, fileB.txt, fileC.txt)

8 Test Cases and Results

8.1 TC0 (1pt): Working-directory file filtering via get_file_info()

Goal: Verify only valid files in the working directory are advertised; ignore subdirectories and .py/.dll/.so; report integer mtimes.

Setup: In src/Peer1/ create:

- fileA.txt
- junk.dll, junk.so, temp.py
- subfolder sub/ containing subfile.txt

Steps:

1. Start tracker and peers.

2. Observe directory response received by any peer.

Expected:

- Only `fileA.txt` appears in the advertised directory from Peer1.
- `mtime` values are integers.

Observed: Only `fileA.txt` was listed (filtered files and subfolder were not). Example from directory response:

```
"fileA.txt": {"ip": "127.0.0.1", "port": 8000, "mtime": 1771289241}
```

Result: PASS.

8.2 TC1 (1pt): Next available port selection

Goal: Verify each peer binds to an available port (no collisions).

Steps:

1. Start tracker (9000).
2. Start three peers.

Expected: Each peer prints a listening port and no bind errors occur.

Observed (this run):

```
Peer1: Waiting for connections on port 8000  
Peer2: Waiting for connections on port 8001  
Peer3: Waiting for connections on port 8002
```

Result: PASS.

8.3 TC2 (1pt): Initializer + tracker connection + keepalive cycles

Goal: Verify sockets are initialized correctly, peers connect to tracker, send Init, and continue with KeepAlive (directory responses repeated over time).

Steps:

1. Start tracker and peers.
2. Observe tracker accepts connections and peers receive directory responses.
3. Wait ≥ 10 seconds and confirm additional directory responses occur (keepalive cycles).

Expected: Tracker logs 3 connections; peers receive directory JSON repeatedly.

Observed: Tracker showed three connections (ports 51543, 51545, 51546) and peers repeatedly printed received from tracker: `{...}`.

Result: PASS.

8.4 TC3 (1pt): Discovery and retrieve missing files (convergence)

Goal: Verify peers download missing files and converge to the same directory.

Setup (before run):

- Peer1 has only `fileA.txt`
- Peer2 has only `fileB.txt`
- Peer3 has only `fileC.txt`

Steps:

1. Run `src\bats\clean_peer.bat`.
2. Start tracker and peers.
3. Wait 1–2 sync cycles.
4. Check each peer folder contents.

Expected: Each peer ends with A/B/C.

Observed (after run):

```
Peer1: fileA.txt fileB.txt fileC.txt
Peer2: fileA.txt fileB.txt fileC.txt
Peer3: fileA.txt fileB.txt fileC.txt
```

Result: PASS.

8.5 TC4 (1pt): Overwrite newer version + verify mtime set via `os.utime()`

Goal: Verify a newer file version overwrites older copies and that the local mtime matches the advertised mtime.

Steps:

1. Stop all peers (or run `src\bats\clean_port.bat`).
2. Append a line to `src/Peer2/fileB.txt` and save (mtime increases).
3. Restart tracker and peers; wait 1–2 sync cycles.
4. Record mtimes using the helper script:

```
cd src
python tests\tc_4.py Peer2\fileB.txt
python tests\tc_4.py Peer1\fileB.txt
python tests\tc_4.py Peer3\fileB.txt
```

5. Confirm content equality using:

```
cd src
python tests\compare_files.py Peer2\fileB.txt Peer1\fileB.txt
python tests\compare_files.py Peer2\fileB.txt Peer3\fileB.txt
```

Expected:

- Peer1/Peer3 overwrite their `fileB.txt` to match Peer2.
- Peer1/Peer3 integer mtimes equal Peer2's newer mtime (set by `os.utime()`).

Observed: After restart and synchronization, `fileB.txt` on all peers had the same integer modified time and size, indicating that the newer version propagated and that the receiving peers preserved the advertised mtime via `os.utime()`.

```
> python tests\tc_4.py Peer2\fileB.txt
Peer2\fileB.txt: mtime=1771289244 size=38

> python tests\tc_4.py Peer1\fileB.txt
Peer1\fileB.txt: mtime=1771289244 size=38

> python tests\tc_4.py Peer3\fileB.txt
Peer3\fileB.txt: mtime=1771289244 size=38
```

Result: PASS.



```
PROBLEMS 13 OUTPUT DEBUG CONSOLE TERMINAL PORTS

C:\Users\sifra\Desktop\p2p\src>python tests\tc_4.py Peer2\fileB.txt
Peer2\fileB.txt: mtime=1771289244 size=38

C:\Users\sifra\Desktop\p2p\src>python tests\tc_4.py Peer1\fileB.txt
Peer1\fileB.txt: mtime=1771289244 size=38

C:\Users\sifra\Desktop\p2p\src>python tests\tc_4.py Peer3\fileB.txt
Peer3\fileB.txt: mtime=1771289244 size=38
```

Figure 2: tc4

8.6 TC5 (2pt): Peer serving protocol (Content-Length header + exact bytes)

Goal: Verify server replies with correct header and sends exactly that many bytes.

Steps:

1. Ensure peers are running. In this run, Peer3 served files on port **8002**.
2. Run:

```
cd src
python tests\tc_5.py --port 8002 --file fileC.txt
```

Expected:

- Prints Content-Length: N
- Prints bytes=N expected=N

Observed:

```
Content-Length: 38
bytes=38 expected=38
```

Result: PASS.

8.7 TC6 (1pt): Timeout/failure + discard partial file

Goal: Verify failed transfers do not leave partial files and synchronization can recover after peer restart.

Setup: Create a larger file in Peer3 using the helper script:

```
cd src\Peer3
python ..\tests\tc_6.py
```

Steps:

1. Start tracker and peers; confirm directory includes **big.bin**.
2. Delete **src/Peer1/big.bin** if present.
3. Wait for sync to begin, then force-stop Peer3 while transfer is in progress (close the Peer3 terminal).
4. Verify Peer1 does not keep a partial file (no **big.bin.part** remains).

5. Restart Peer3 and wait another sync cycle.
6. Verify the final downloaded file matches Peer3 using:

```
cd src
python tests\compare_files.py Peer3\big.bin Peer1\big.bin
```

Expected:

- If the transfer is interrupted, Peer1 does not keep a partial file (no `.part` remains).
- After Peer3 restarts, Peer1 successfully downloads `big.bin` and it matches Peer3.

Observed: After restarting Peer3 and allowing synchronization to complete, `big.bin` existed on all three peers and had the same size.

```
"C:\Users\sifra\Desktop\p2p\src\Peer1\big.bin" 10240kb
"C:\Users\sifra\Desktop\p2p\src\Peer2\big.bin" 10240kb
"C:\Users\sifra\Desktop\p2p\src\Peer3\big.bin" 10240kb
```

Result: PASS.

9 Patch Update (Feb 27)

I made a few small fixes to improve error handling in `src/fileSynchronizer.py`. Some were around the template. This section briefly explains what changed and how I checked it.

9.1 PF1: Better free-port check

Issue: My earlier version checked port availability by searching the output of `netstat`. That approach is not very reliable, because a port number can appear as part of a different number (for example, 8000 inside 18000).

Fix: I changed `check_port_available()` so it creates a temporary socket and tries to bind directly to `("0.0.0.0", port)`. If the bind works, the port is free.

Quick check:

1. Start Peer1, Peer2, and Peer3 from a clean state.
2. Check that each peer gets its own listening port.

Observed:

```
Peer1: Waiting for connections on port 8000
Peer2: Waiting for connections on port 8001
Peer3: Waiting for connections on port 8002
```

Result: PASS.

9.2 PF2: One failed download should not stop the whole sync

Issue: In the earlier version, if one file download failed, it could interrupt the current sync cycle.

Fix: I updated the `sync()` logic so that a failed `syncfile(...)` call is skipped, and the peer continues checking the rest of the files instead of stopping.

Quick check:

1. Use the TC6 setup with `big.bin` stored on Peer3.

2. Interrupt Peer3 while Peer1 is downloading the file.
3. Leave the other peers running and watch the next sync cycles.

Observed: A failed transfer no longer stops later sync attempts. After Peer3 was started again, the missing file was downloaded successfully in a later cycle.

Result: PASS.

9.3 PF3: Safer server accept loop

Issue: The peer server loop originally accepted incoming connections without much protection. If something went wrong during `accept()` or thread startup, the peer could exit unexpectedly.

Fix: I added basic `try/except` handling around `accept()` and around the thread start, with a safe close if a connection object had already been created.

Quick check:

1. Run the tracker and all peers normally.
2. Let them exchange files for several sync cycles.
3. Run TC5 at the same time to create extra peer requests.

Observed: The peers continued serving requests normally and stayed running during repeated sync cycles.

Result: PASS.

9.4 Patch sanity check

To make sure the updated file still parsed correctly after the changes, I also ran a quick syntax check.

Command run:

```
python -c "import ast, pathlib; ast.parse(pathlib.Path('src/fileSynchronizer.py').
    read_text(encoding='utf-8')); print('OK')"
```

Observed:

OK

Result: PASS.

10 Results Summary

Rubric Requirement / Test Case	Result
TC0: <code>get_file_info()</code> filtering rules (1pt)	PASS
TC1: <code>get_next_available_port()</code> (1pt)	PASS
TC2: Initializer + tracker comms + keepalive (1pt)	PASS
TC3: <code>sync()</code> discovery + retrieve missing (1pt)	PASS
TC4: <code>sync()</code> overwrite newer + set mtime (1pt)	PASS
TC5: <code>process_message()</code> Content-Length + exact bytes (2pt)	PASS
TC6: Failure handling + discard partial file (1pt)	PASS
PF1: Patch check - reliable free-port detection	PASS
PF2: Patch check - skip failed download, continue sync	PASS
PF3: Patch check - guarded accept/thread handling	PASS